

Forward Arrow Services

AI Use Case Definition Checklist

Use this checklist to define a real, actionable AI use case before tools are selected or implemented.

1. Define the Actual Problem

- ☐ What specific problem are we trying to solve?
- ☐ Who is currently experiencing this problem?
- ☐ How is this problem handled today (manual process, workaround, etc.)?
- ☐ What is the cost of doing nothing? (time, money, risk, frustration)?

2. Define the Target Outcome

- ☐ What does success look like in measurable terms?
- ☐ How will we know this worked?
- ☐ What would improvement look like in 30-60 days?
- ☐ Is this outcome realistic with current data and workflows?

3. Identify the Right Use Case

- ☐ Is this task repetitive, time-consuming, or error-prone?
- ☐ Does this involve structured or semi-structured data?
- ☐ Would automation assist - not replace - human judgment?
- ☐ Can this be tested on a small scale first?

4. Risk & Compliance Check

- ☐ Does this involve sensitive data (PHI, PII, PCI)?
- ☐ Are we clear on what data can and cannot be used?
- ☐ Do we understand the compliance requirements (HIPAA, PCI-DSS, etc.)?
- ☐ Is there a human review step before final decisions/actions?

5. Human Oversight

- ☐ Who is responsible for reviewing AI outputs?
- ☐ Who is accountable if something goes wrong?
- ☐ Are staff trained to recognize incorrect or risky outputs?
- ☐ Is there a clear stop or rollback process?

6. Pilot Before Scale

- ☐ Can this be tested with a limited dataset or process?
- ☐ Have we defined success/failure criteria for the pilot?
- ☐ Are we tracking results during the test?
- ☐ Do we have a plan to adjust before expanding?

7. Measure What Matters

- ☐ What metric are we improving? (time saved, error reduction, etc.)
- ☐ How will results be tracked and reported?
- ☐ Are we comparing against a baseline?
- ☐ Is the improvement meaningful to the business?

8. Boundaries & Guardrails

- ☐ What should this AI system never be used for?
- ☐ Are there clear limitations documented for staff?
- ☐ Is the system restricted from making final decisions?
- ☐ Are escalation paths clearly defined?

Final Readiness Check

- ☐ We have a clearly defined problem
- ☐ We have a measurable outcome
- ☐ We understand the risks
- ☐ We have human oversight in place
- ☐ We are starting with a controlled pilot

If these boxes are not checked, the initiative is not ready.

Forward Arrow Services helps organizations define, test, and implement AI safely - without hype.

Competence, it turns out, still matters.